



The USA finished the Paris Games as the most successful nation in athletics, with 34 medals, including 14 gold. Kenya took second place with 11 medals, four of which were gold, bolstered by its dominance in long-distance races.

Among individual athletes, the USA's Gabrielle Thomas earned the most silverware, claiming three gold medals in the women's 200m, 4x100m relay, and 4x400m relay.

The Indian angle

From an Indian perspective, the year's highlight was the Paris

Olympics javelin throw final, with the country's hopes for a gold medal resting on the shoulders of reigning champion Neeraj Chopra.

However, Pakistan's Arshad Nadeem emerged as the dark horse, setting a competition record twice on his way to a historic first-ever individual Olympic gold medal for Pakistan, while Neeraj settled for silver. Neeraj's second consecutive Olympic medal wasn't enough to overshadow the underwhelming performance of the rest of the Indian athletics contingent. Only one other athlete, Avinash Sable in the men's

Dual glory:

Sydney McLaughlin-Levrone secured two gold medals at the 2024 Paris Olympics, playing a key role in Team USA's triumph in the 4x400m relay and dominating the 400m hurdles. REUTERS

3,000m steeplechase, reached a final, as India endured a frustrating campaign at the Stade de France.

Outside the Olympics, long-distance runner Gulveer Singh became the talk of the town in Indian athletics.

The 26-year-old began 2024 by